

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with a year's hands-on experience supporting complex litigation and international arbitration at BCLP, alongside current case management and client advisory work at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Experienced in preparing electronic and hard-copy hearing bundles, document review, legal and factual research, drafting procedural documents, monitoring deadlines and maintaining organised case files. Comfortable managing competing priorities across several matters at once. Currently completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary University of London.

EDUCATION

- | | |
|--|------------------------------|
| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules in international arbitration, cross-border dispute resolution, procedural law, evidence analysis and legal research• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions• Transnational Law and Governance Applied module — 75% | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law | |
| International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Aug 2023 – Feb 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended memorial sections and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories• Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission• Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator• Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Prepared electronic hearing bundles and hard-copy court materials; assisted with skeleton arguments and court filings• Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes• Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage• Assisted with hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons | |

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead	July 2026 – Present
--	----------------------------

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies, identifies legal and evidential issues, drafts correspondence and prepares document schedules
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance
- Maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across multiple concurrent matters

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused, accessible advice

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; document review and electronic bundling; iManage; electronic court filing portals (CE-File); case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; qualitative interviewing; concise report and correspondence drafting**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation (electronic and hard copy), procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters